

out the uid/user/userid and pass/key/passphrase. Then put that in the following format while adding the RSS feed.

<http://torrentsite.com/rss.php?COOKIE:uid=maharaja;pass=ahukkipukki99j>

3. Now go to **Options > RSS Down-loader** (Short-cut key Ctrl+R). Under the left column click on 'Add'. Type in a name for your filter.
4. **Filter:** Then in the edit box next to the filter add your filter while following these rules.
 - Separate each filter using [|]
 - Use [*] or [?] to denote wildcards to match a portion of the text string that you are searching for.
 - Restrict the usage of specific episode numbers of season numbers. You'll have to regularly keep fixing your filter every few months unless you do that.
5. **Not:** Whatever filters you include here will be used to remove the torrent from the download list. Now if the steam features both SD (Standard Definition) and HD (High Definition) but you wish to download only HD then putting SD here will ensure that all SD torrents that match your filters are not downloaded.
6. **Save in:** Type in the directory where you want your show to be stored.
7. **Feed:** Select the feed on which you want these filters to be applied.
8. **Quality:** Certain websites follow a standard for all uploads. You may select the quality of the download you wish to acquire and if the website adheres to the standard then uTorrent will download the appropriate quality file.
9. **Episode Number:** Often, sites undergo maintenance and quite often end up messing the feed which could mean an entire season's feed being re-published. Now, unless you wish to download the entire season all over again, you might want to set an episode number here. Only episodes that follow this will be downloaded. There are multiple formats for setting this filter.
 - If you wish to download a range of episodes (say 5-8) under season '6', then type in '6x5-6x8'.
 - To start any particular season from a particular episode (say season 7 episode 4 onwards), type in '7x4'.
10. Checking the "Don't start downloads automatically" will add the torrents

to your 'Inactive' list so that you can choose which to download after reviewing the list.

11. Checking the 'Give download highest priority' will ensure all torrents filtered from the feed get highest priority.
12. Setting the minimum interval ensures that uTorrent does not download another torrent which matches the filter for the said number of days. Quite useful for avoiding duplicates. So if the show which you are into releases every 5 days then setting it to 4-5 will ensure all matches within that period are ignored.
13. **Label:** If you set a particular custom label here then all downloaded torrents will be assigned the said label. This helps out a lot when you have to sort through hundreds of torrents.

Finally, there is the king-of-automators, AutoHotkey. As a topic covered extensively in the past, we will have to move past this very quickly. But, if you're new to this, here is a snapshot of the things that you can get done with this app: it can mimic keyboard and mouse inputs; manipulate your windows files and folders; monitor your computer to end unwanted processes; schedule tasks like backup, defragmentation and fill out online forms, among many (many)



Make your Linux PC your assistant

more. That's pretty much all the digital housekeeping you need. It can't make you a sandwich, though. Here's a quick refresher for the uninitiated:

1. Download the Autohotkey executable from <http://dgit.in/PP7aRJ> Install it to your hard disk.
2. Click on your Start Menu, locate the 'Startup' folder and right click > Open.
3. Create a new text file called Auto-hotkey.ahk
4. Head over to <http://dgit.in/MqL3RC> to customize your Autohotkey script. You can use the unused keys on your desktop's keyboard and automate nearly any action.

As an added bonus, the software is available for Linux too. Read more on our coverage at <http://dgit.in/autoht>.

Linux

Linux is one of the most automation-friendly platforms, and practically anything that you want automated can be scripted using Bash or Python. Scripts are basically a collection of commands stored in a text file, and the shell can read these as if they were actually written to the command prompt. They allow you to automate almost any task, such as creating backups of your data, downloading or uploading material from predefined locations, making storage repositories, even sending you periodic e-mails about the progress, based on some criteria. Head over to <http://dgit.in/NfLxqm> for some examples of scripting operations. Since a full-fledged tutorial in scripting is beyond

HOME AUTOMATION

Home automation might seem like a farfetched idea, but it is really closer to you than you think. Work has been going on for years, to make intelligent homes a reality. There are various protocols in existence that promise to achieve that dream. The first is the Jini architecture. Originally developed by Sun, it was later declared open source, and transferred to Apache. It basically defines an architecture that harnesses the power of the Java over distributed, mutually supportive systems. It is akin to Java's 'Remote Method Invocation', just in a more advanced form.

What that means is that any device that runs Java (and Java runs on a hell of a lot of machines, and not just computers) can intercommunicate using this technology. Look at more information on Jini at <http://dgit.in/KXcujd>. The next notable platform in the field of hardware automation is the X10 architecture. This is actually more of a private protocol, with an industry standard being released for communication between proper, non-computing hardware devices by the use of ports and bridges. Its application is pretty widespread. Find out more at www.x10.com.